

OK! Look, we're not going to pull any punches here. If we're encouraging you to think big, create a start-up, and risk your livelihood, it would be unfair for us to be anything but blunt. What follows takes balls (yes we said it, and don't drown us in semantics if you're woman, it still takes balls...). You have to have passion, commitment, a really good idea, friends in high (and sometimes low) places, a more than average intellect, great networking skills, and a whole range of other skills that are too numerable to list here. You also need a good support system at home, encouragement and a generally positive outlook on life. Now hang on, we're not trying to discourage you, we're just saying that all of the above is required, and more. Thankfully all of the above can be learnt or might even come naturally to some of you. We're here to give you that 5 per cent extra that can make all the difference in the world. Keep reading, if you dare...

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